

I am a friend

There isn't a dearth of naysayers when it comes to discussing the field of robotics. In fact, the debate about robots stealing human jobs has never been louder at any other point in history. But as every Digit reader will know, harboring a feeling of fear towards technology is only something that fools do, and any technological advancement is eventually a tool to be used as we see fit. And that is what this book aims to do - to tell you that robots are your friends if you want them to be and you should know more about them.

To start off, familiarising yourself with what constitutes a robot is very important. Just how smart does a smart washing machine need to be before you can call it a robot? This distinction goes a long way in taking robotics in the right direction. It is also important to know how robotics has fared over the years and why it has taken the direction it has to reach where it is now. The first few chapters in this book should take care of all of this.

Moving on, we look at what really constitutes a robot - its mind and its matter. Have you ever wondered where all those fancy prototypes, that keep popping up on your social feeds, are now and why don't you see a pet robot dog in every household right now? We did a little research, and what we found out constitutes the next portion of this book.

Eventually, the big question arises - how will humans fare against robots? And if the situation ever arises where humans HAVE to fare against robots, what rules will they fight by? Understanding the direction robots are taking in our labs is crucial to determining that the future being foretold by the naysayers doesn't become a reality. Of late, that seems to happen quite a lot *cough*POTUS*cough*.

The best way to understand the reality that we live in, with respect to robotics, is to look at some of the most interesting robotics projects being undertaken around the world. We are not just talking about niche R&D being done in secret labs, but also college kids building amazing things and open sourcing them.

And remember, robots can be anything that you choose them to be - good, bad, or even a vacuum cleaner. 